

Incident Investigation Report

Module 4: Malware Analysis & Threat Intelligence
Investigation

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Date : 5-5-2026

Executive Summary

This report presents the findings of a malware analysis and threat intelligence investigation conducted on a suspicious file with the SHA256 hash
1adc29f30b30e301acefe1b46bbbd7a4f3a76c3708ab842199e95f8f5f053244.

The file, identified as izup.exe, was analyzed using VirusTotal and the ANY.RUN cloud sandbox.

This investigation confirms that the file is a malicious infostealer which belongs to the AgentTesla malware group.

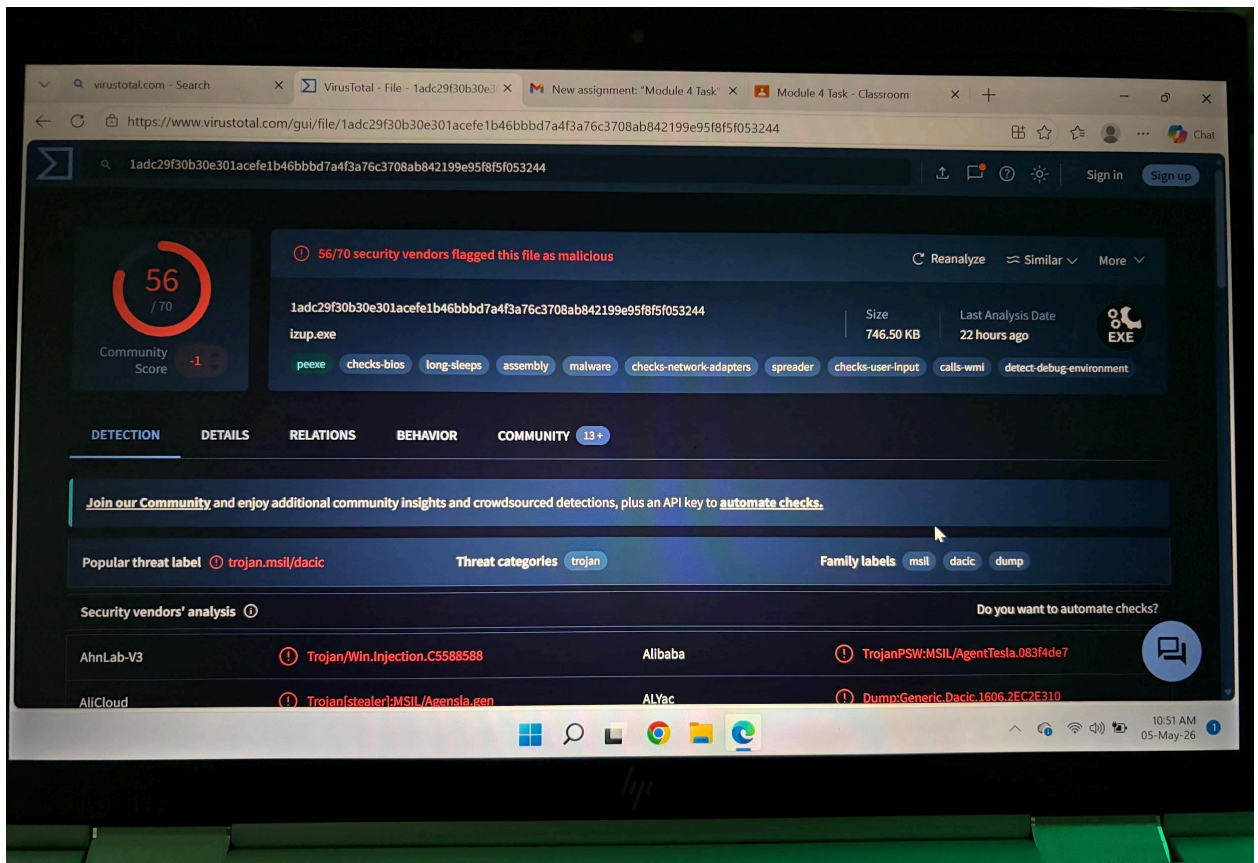
The malware poses a significant threat to organizational security and requires immediate detection and containment measures.

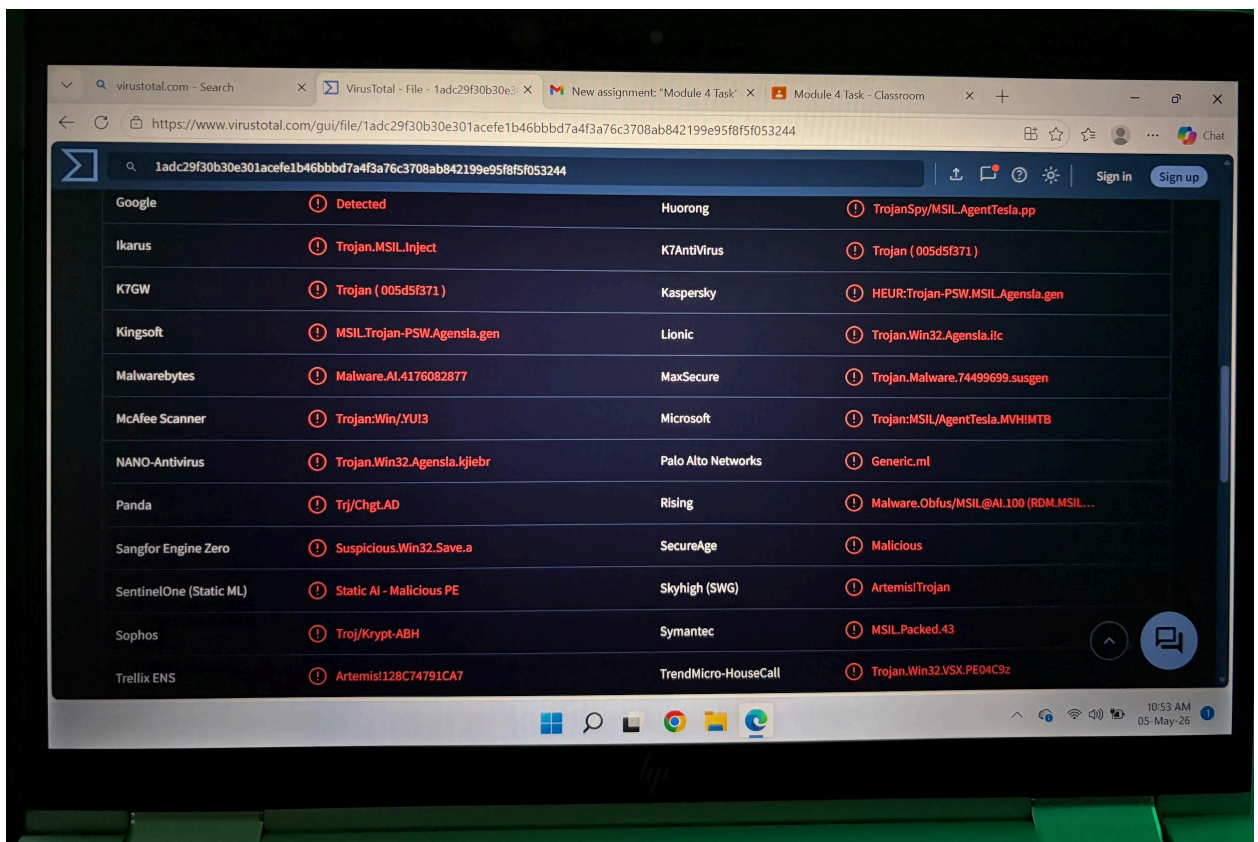
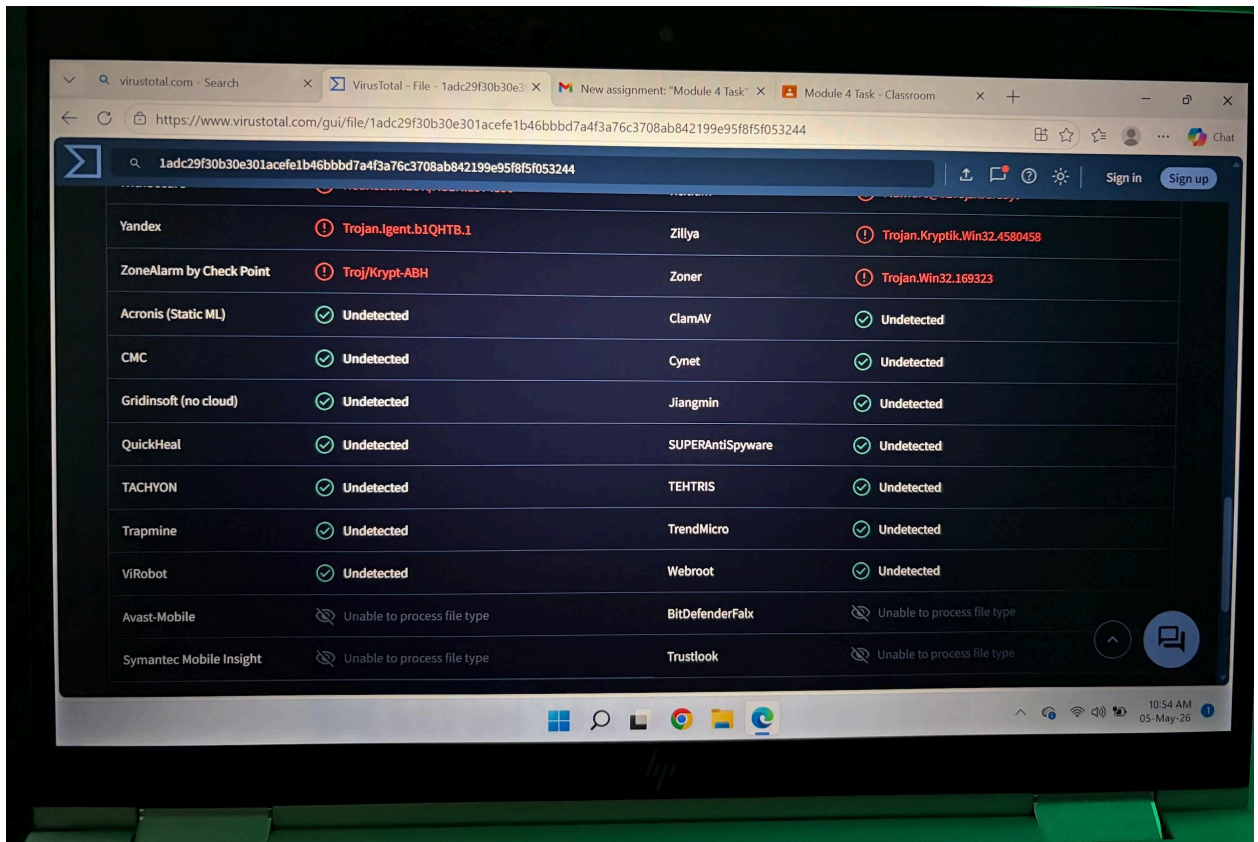
Section 1: VirusTotal Analysis

Detection Summary:

- Number of engines that flagged it: 56/70
- File type: Win32 EXE
- Detection names: Trojan:MSIL/AgentTesla, MSIL/Kryptik, Trojan.Win32.Agensla, MSIL/Formbook, Dump:Generic.Dacic
- First seen: February 14, 2024

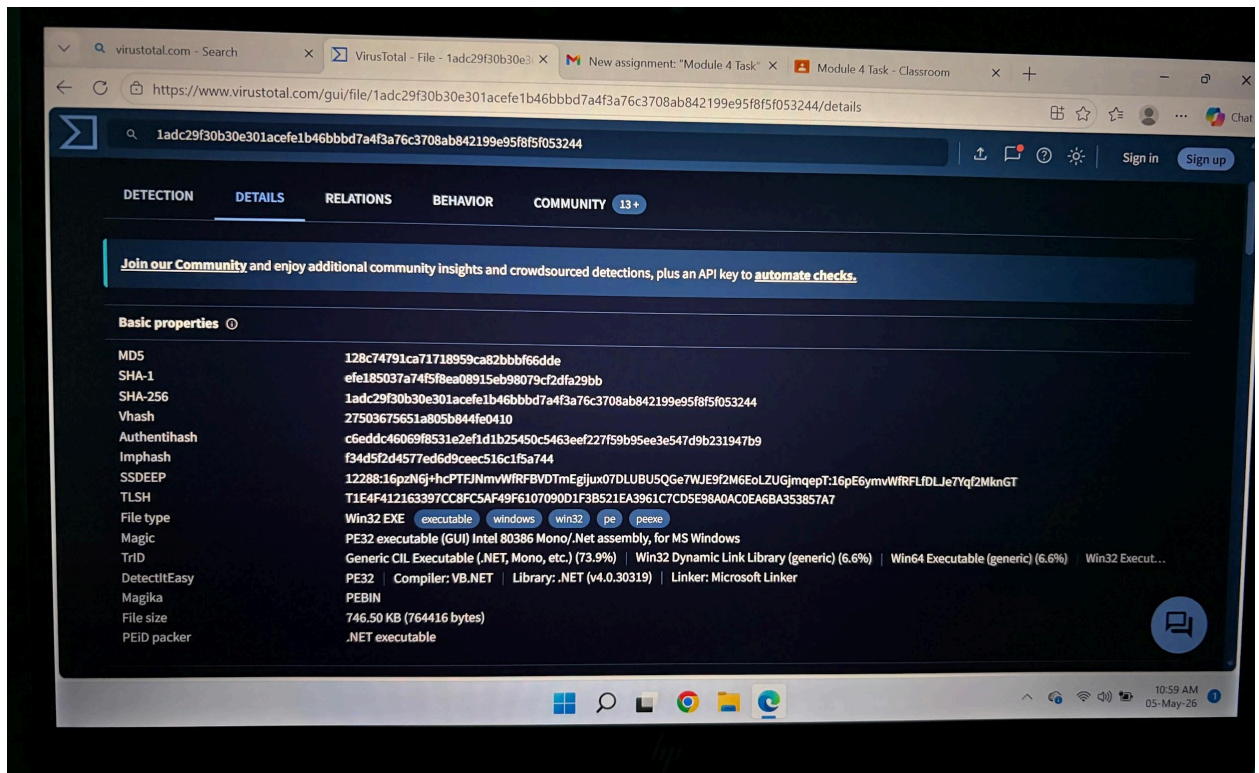
- Last seen: January 1, 2026.





File Identification:

- File name: izup.exe
- Original submission source: Uploaded as izup.exe, also seen as "Inflated Price listfLs83CTEnBXKnJT.scr" and fAjLxt.exe
- File type and architecture: PE32 executable, Intel 80386, .NET assembly, 32-bit
- MD5: 128C74791CA71718959CA82BBBF66DDE
- SHA1: EFE185037A74F5F8EA08915EB98079CF2DFA29BB
- SHA256:
1ADC29F30B30E301ACEFE1B46BBBD7A4F3A76C3708AB842199E95F8F5F053244

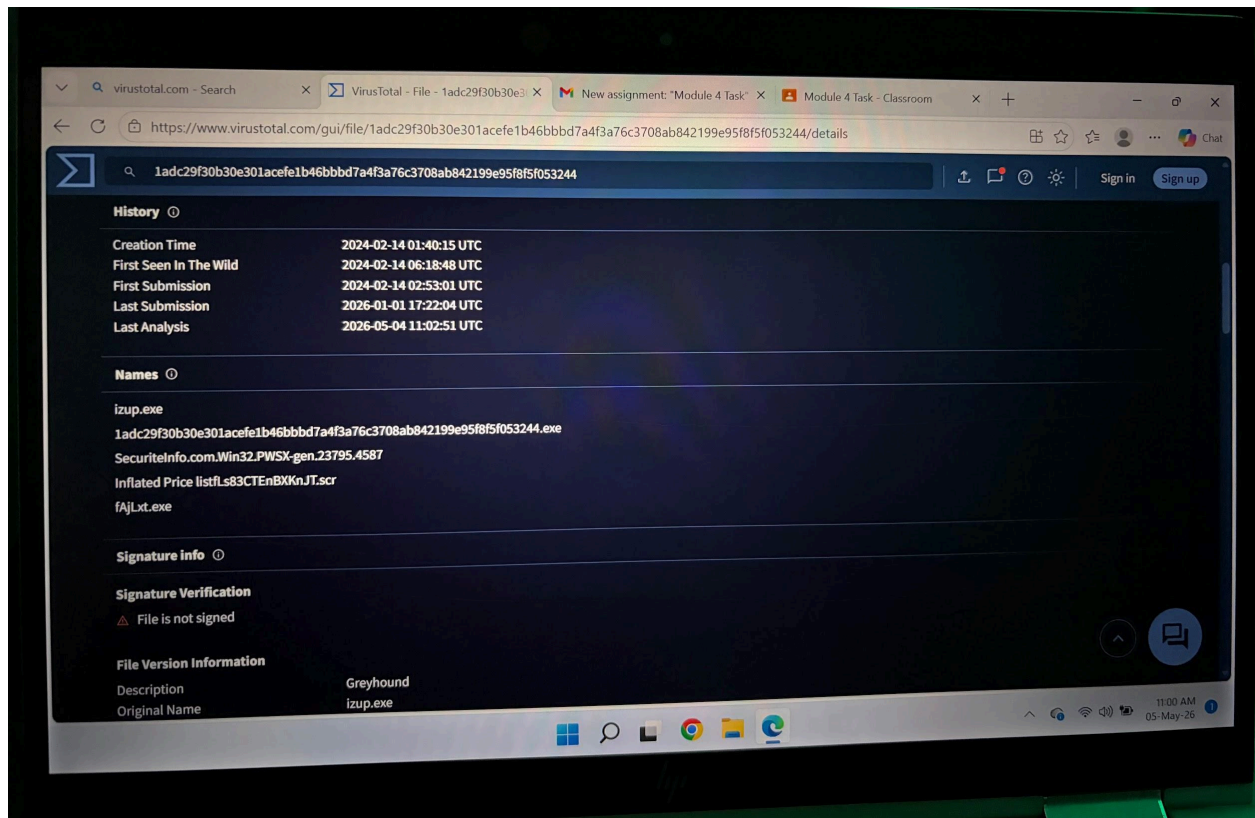


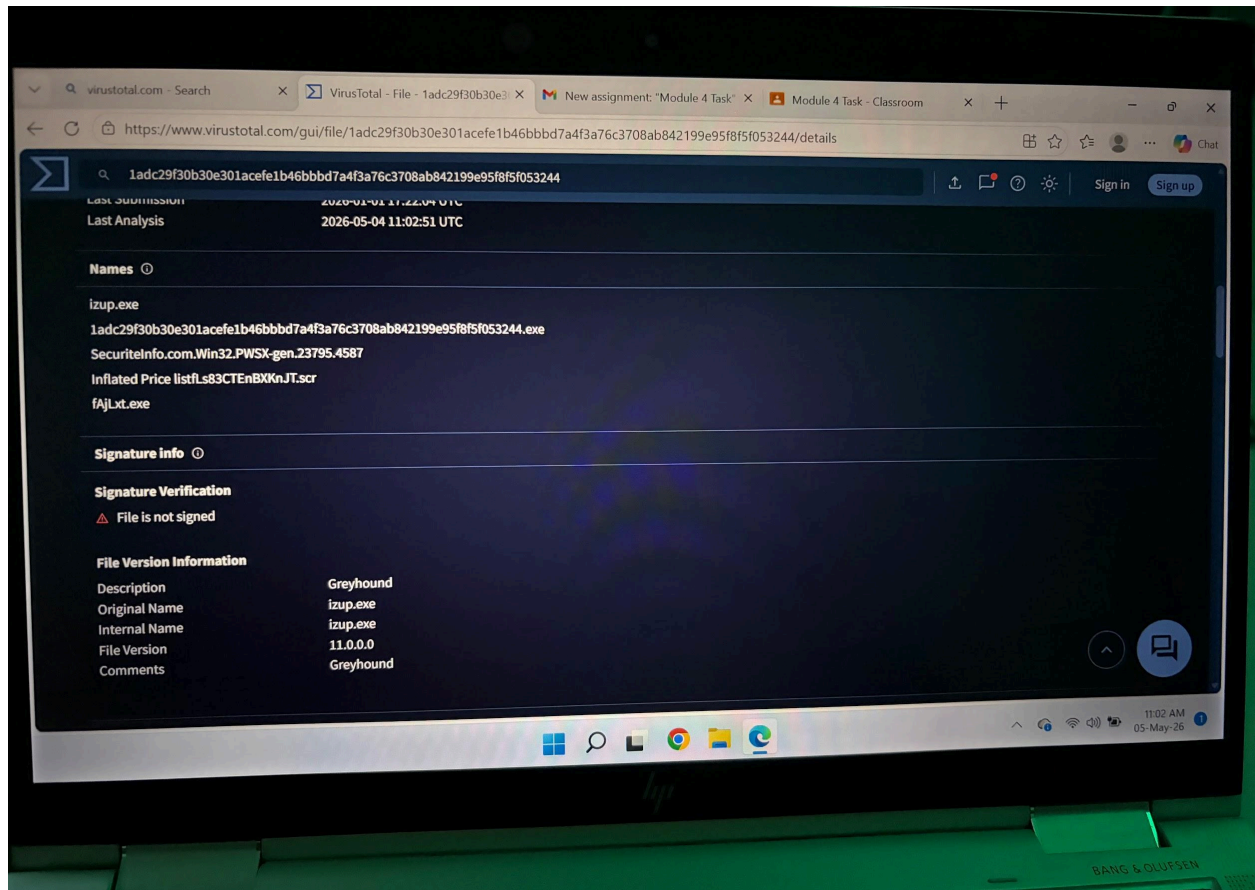
Examination:

Metadata & Version Info:

- File version: 11.0.0.0
- Internal name: izup.exe
- Spoofed company: NTT (real global IT company)
- Spoofed product: Greyhound
- File is NOT digitally signed

- Masquerading as legitimate tile editor software





Static Network Indicators:

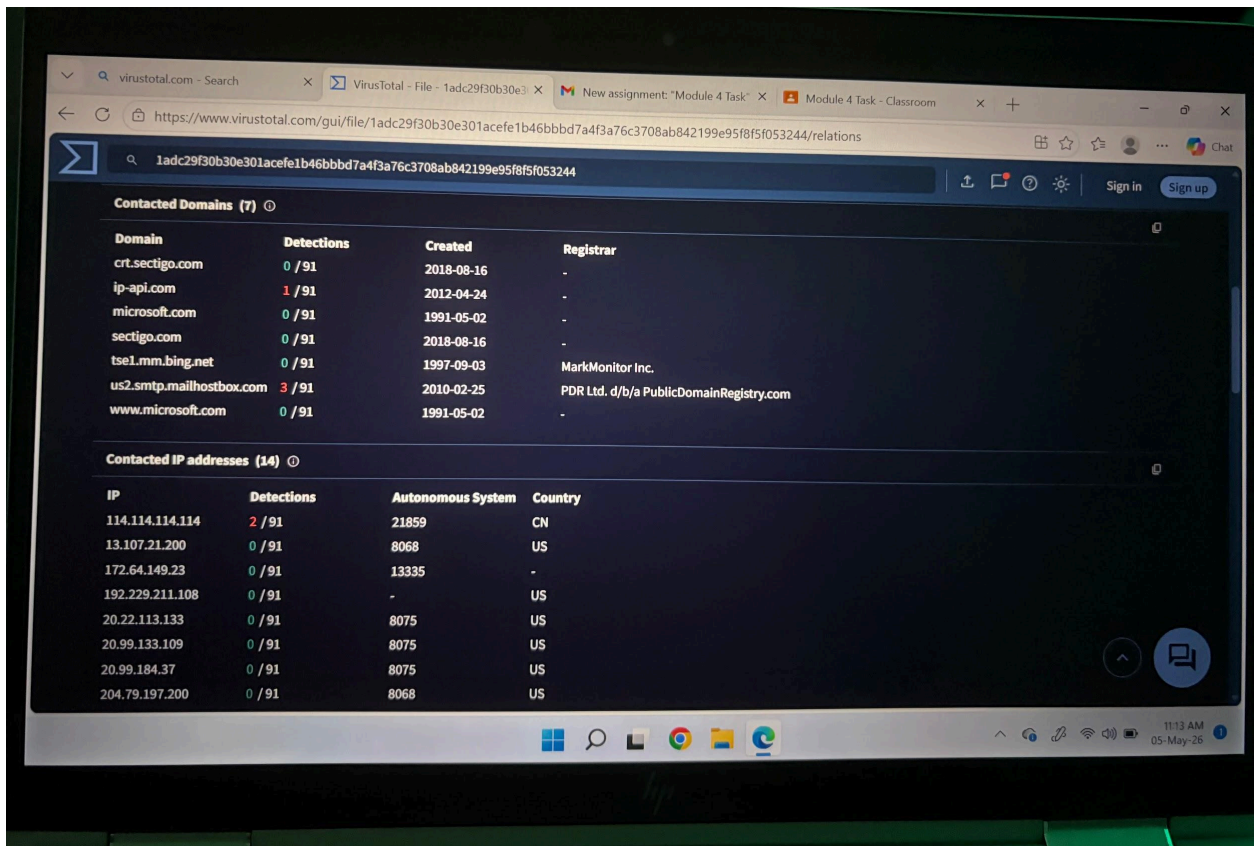
Domains:

- ip-api.com
- us2.smtp.mailhostbox.com
- crt.sectigo.com
- www.microsoft.com

IPs:

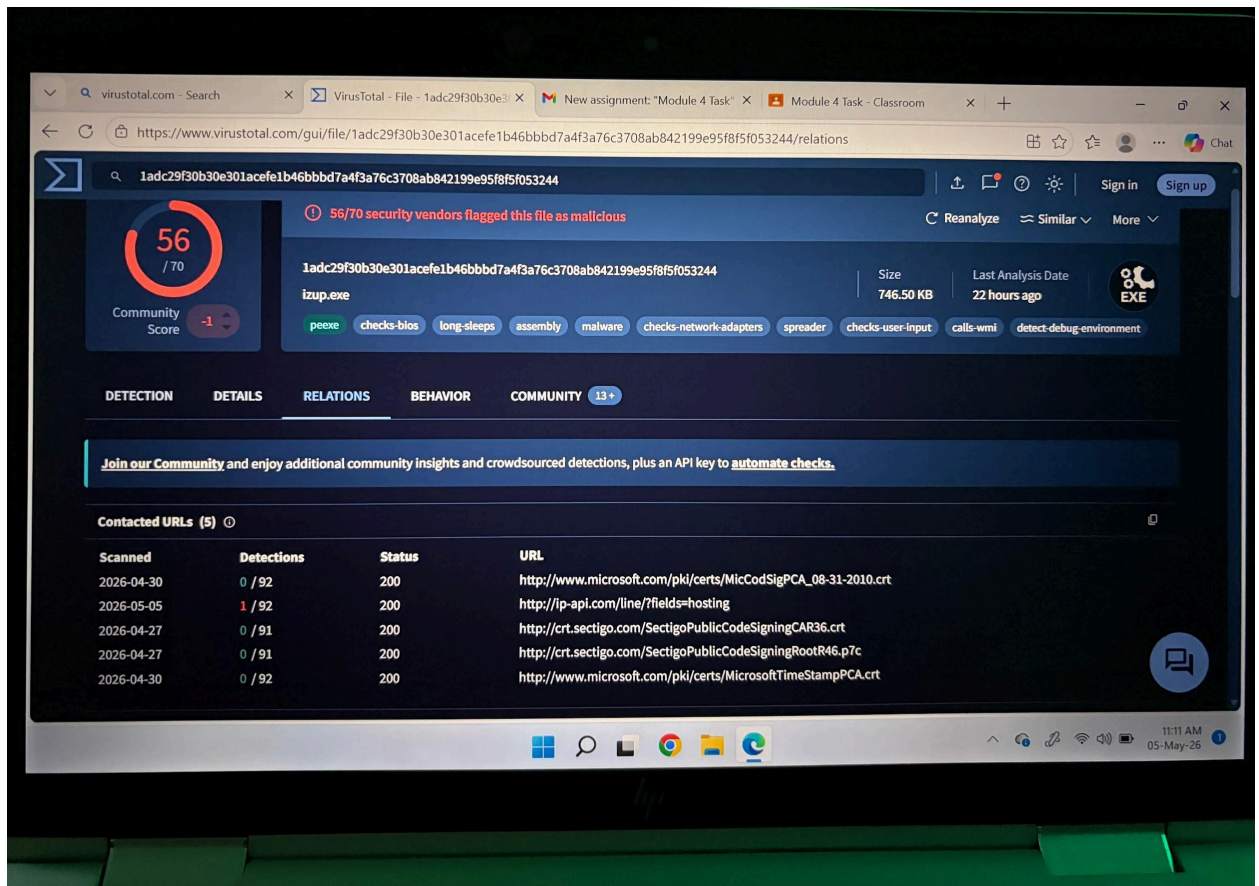
- 208.95.112.1
- 208.91.199.224

- 114.114.114.114



URLs:

- <http://ip-api.com/line/?fields=hosting>



Persistence & Registry References:

- Scheduled task created: Updates\fAjLxt
- Registry keys set under: HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Schedule\TaskCache
- PowerShell used to exclude malware from Windows Defender: Add-MpPreference -ExclusionPath fAjLxt.exe

Section 2:

ANY.RUN Sandbox Analysis

Malware Family & Confidence Level:

- Malware Family: AgentTesla
- Confidence Level in Classification: High

Sandbox Behavioral Findings:

Key Process Behavior:

- Uses Task Scheduler to run other applications

- Steals credentials from web browsers
- Connects to SMTP port for data exfiltration
- Actions consistent with stealing personal data

Persistence Attempts:

- Scheduled task created: Updates\FAjLxt
- Malware copies itself to %APPDATA%\FAjLxt.exe

Privilege Escalation / Evasion Attempts:

- Process injection detected
- Anti-behavioral and anti-static analysis techniques used
- Hides artifacts and creates hidden files and directories
- Excludes itself from Windows Defender using PowerShell

Network Behavior :

Connections Attempted:

- HTTP(S) requests: 6
- TCP/UDP connections: 32
- DNS requests: 16
- Network threats detected: 5

Protocols Used:

- HTTP
- SMTP
- DNS

Suspicious Domains or IPs Contacted:

- ip-api.com (208.95.112.1) — geo-location lookup
- us2.smtp.mailhostbox.com (208.91.199.224) data exfiltration via email

Payloads / Observed Actions

Files Created or Modified:

- %APPDATA%\FAjLxt.exe
- %TEMP%\tmp42A1.tmp
- software.exe.log
- %TEMP%\tmp8CA5.tmp

Commands Executed:

- schtasks.exe /Create /TN "Updates\FAjLxt" /XML "%TEMP%\tmp42A1.tmp"
- powershell.exe Add-MpPreference -ExclusionPath "%APPDATA%\FAjLxt.exe"

Inference Question

1• Based on static analysis, this malware is compiled as [a.NET](#) assembly, disguised as legitimate software (Greyhound/NTT), it is unsigned, and contains embedded SMTP credentials used for data exfiltration.

This malware is an infostealer and Trojan, these characteristics are associated with the AgentTesla infostealer family.

2• The malware is disguised as a legitimate business document which was seen from one of its file names “Inflated Price listfLs83CTEnBXKnJT.scr” which suggests that it was likely delivered via a phishing email with a fake price list or invoice attachment, targeting business employees into opening it.

3• As a Tier 1 analyst, I would first identify the attack by monitoring SIEM alerts for suspicious process creations like schtasks.exe and powershell.exe being spawned by an unknown executable.

I would also look for outbound SMTP connections on port 587 to unknown hosts, and any process making requests to [ip-api.com](#) , after identifying all the indicators, I would separate the affected endpoint, document the IOCs, afterwards escalate to Tier 2 for deeper forensic investigation.

Conclusion

This investigation revealed that izup.exe is not just another malicious file.

It is a carefully crafted infostealer that silently steals credentials, hides itself from antivirus, and sends stolen data to an attacker-controlled email account without the victim ever knowing.

The fact that it disguises itself as a legitimate software product shows the level of effort attackers put into making malware harder to detect.

As analysts, identifying threats like this early through SIEM monitoring, endpoint detection, and threat intelligence platforms like VirusTotal and ANY.RUN is what stands between an organization and a serious data breach.